

Installing EpisodeSleuth on Windows

This guide walks you through setting up everything **EpisodeSleuth** (the phonetic dialogue fingerprinting system) needs on a Windows machine. No programming experience required.

In a hurry? Just double-click `install.bat` - it runs the automated setup script which handles everything below. The manual steps are here in case you prefer to do it yourself.

Just want a runnable app with no Python at all? Build (or obtain) a standalone executable instead - see [BUILD_EXECUTABLES.md](#). You get a `dist\EpisodeSleuth\EpisodeSleuth.exe` you can double-click; only `ffmpeg` is still needed at run time.

What you need

Component	Why	Install method
Python 3.10+	Runs all the scripts	<code>winget install Python.Python.3.12</code> or python.org
FFmpeg	Decodes video/audio so the STT engine can process it	<code>winget install Gyan.FFmpeg</code> or ffmpeg.org
Vosk speech model	Offline speech-to-text engine (phonetic matching)	Downloaded automatically by <code>install.ps1</code>
Python packages	PySide6-Fluent-Widgets, Vosk, metaphone, etc.	<code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code>

Option A: Automatic (recommended)

1. Open the project folder in File Explorer.
2. **Double-click** `install.bat`.
3. Follow any prompts (it may ask to install Python or FFmpeg via `winget`).
4. When it says "Setup complete", you are done. A Desktop shortcut ("EpisodeSleuth") will have been created.

From PowerShell you can also run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1
```

Useful flags:

Flag	Effect
-NoVenv	Install Python packages into the system Python instead of a <code>.venv</code>
-NoModel	Skip the Vosk model download
-NoShortcut	Do not create Desktop / Start-menu shortcuts
-Force	Reinstall packages and re-download the model even if present

Option B: Manual step-by-step

1. Install Python 3

Download from python.org (tick “Add Python to PATH” during install), or via winget:

```
winget install Python.Python.3.12
```

Verify:

```
python --version
```

2. Install FFmpeg

FFmpeg is needed to decode audio from video files so the speech-to-text engine can process it.

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

Or download manually from ffmpeg.org, extract, and add the `bin\` folder to your system PATH.

Verify:

```
ffmpeg -version
```

3. Install Python packages

From the project folder:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs PySide6-Fluent-Widgets (the GUI toolkit), Vosk (speech-to-text), Double Metaphone (phonetic encoding), and other dependencies.

4. Download the Vosk speech model

The offline speech-to-text engine needs a language model. Download and extract the small English model:

1. Download: <https://alphacephei.com/vosk/models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15.zip>
2. Extract the zip so you get a folder `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`
3. Move that folder into the project's `models\` directory:

```
models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\
```

(`install.ps1` does this automatically.)

Running the app

- **GUI:** double-click the **EpisodeSleuth** shortcut (or `fluent_launcher.bat`), or run `python -m audio_fingerprint.gui`
- **CLI:** `python -m audio_fingerprint.cli.identify --dir "C:\path\to\dvd_rips"`

See [README.md](#) and [USAGE_DVD.md](#) for full usage.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
<code>python</code> not found	Make sure “Add Python to PATH” was ticked during install, or open a new terminal
<code>ffmpeg</code> not found	Open a new terminal (PATH refresh), or add FFmpeg’s <code>bin\</code> folder to PATH manually
Vosk model errors	Check that <code>models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\</code> exists and contains model files
GUI won’t start	Run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again to ensure PySide6-Fluent-Widgets is installed